ANELDA BOTES



# Animals: What Can They Do?

A1 | Young learners, 7–9 | 20 minutes

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|---|---|
| **Aim** | Students can ask and answer about animal abilities with *can / can't*. |
| **Language** | **Can a fish swim?** — Yes, it can. / No, it can't.<br>Verbs: swim, fly, run, jump, climb · Animals: fish, bird, monkey, frog, elephant, penguin |
| **Materials** | 6 animal flashcards, 5 action cards, a soft ball, small animal card sets (one per pair), two marker colours |

## Stages

**0–3 min — Warm-up: Simon Says** Whole class
"Stand up! Simon says… swim like a fish!" Run through all five verbs. Add one trick without "Simon says".

**3–8 min — Present the language** T → class
Monkey card: "Can a monkey climb?" Nod, mime: "Yes, it can!" Fish card: "Can a fish climb?" "No, it can't!" Elicit more.
**CCQs:** "Can a fish swim? (Yes.) Can a fish climb? (No.)" Drill chorally, then groups, then individuals. Back-chain "…it can't."

**8–13 min — Ball pass** Open pairs
Demo with a strong student: ask, throw; they answer, ask someone new, throw.
**ICQs:** "Who asks? (Person with the ball.) Then? (Throw.)"

**13–18 min — Guess my animal** Closed pairs
A hides a card. B asks up to three questions ("Can it fly?"), then guesses: "Is it a penguin?" Swap.
**ICQs:** "Can B see the card? (No!) How many questions? (Three.)" Monitor and note errors.

**18–20 min — Wrap-up** Whole class
Board two errors ("A fish can't flies"); class fixes them. Thumbs quiz: "Can a penguin fly?" Specific praise.

## Board plan

- Left: pictures of the 5 verbs
- Centre: Can a fish swim? → Yes, it can. ✓ / No, it can't. ×
- Mark weak /kən/ in questions, strong /kæn/ in answers
- Right: errors for wrap-up

## Timing plan B

- **Late:** cut the ball pass to 3 min, never the wrap-up
- **Early:** team race — make a true sentence about a card for a point

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# My Day: How Often Do You...?

A2 | Older kids, 10–12 | 20 minutes

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|---|---|
| **Aim** | Students can ask and answer about routines with adverbs of frequency in the correct position. |
| **Language** | **How often do you play video games?** — I usually play after school. / I never play on Mondays.<br>always · usually · often · sometimes · never (before the main verb) |
| **Materials** | Frequency scale poster (100% → 0%), sentence strips cut into words, 1 "Find someone who" sheet per student |

## Stages

**0–3 min — Warm-up: Stand up if...** Whole class
"Stand up if you... play football! ...eat rice for breakfast! ...go to bed after 10!" Students sit and stand quickly.

**3–8 min — Present the language** T → class
Show a picture timeline of "my day". "I **always** drink coffee. I **never** eat breakfast!" Place each adverb on the 100% → 0% scale.
**CCQs:** "Sometimes — every day? (No.) Some days? (Yes.) Never — how many days? (Zero.)" Drill the question "How often do you...?"

**8–13 min — Sentence builders** Pairs
Pairs order word strips: *usually / I / walk / school / to*. First pair to finish reads it aloud.
**ICQs:** "Where does 'usually' go — before or after 'walk'? (Before.)"

**13–18 min — Find someone who...** Mingle
Students walk and ask "How often do you...?" to find a classmate for each line, writing their name and answer.
**ICQs:** "Do you ask one person or many? (Many.) What do you write? (Name.)" Monitor and note errors.

**18–20 min — Report back** Whole class
Two students share one fact: "Linh never eats breakfast!" Fix two errors from the board together. Specific praise.

## Board plan

- Left: frequency scale with the 5 adverbs
- Centre: How often do you + verb? / I + adverb + verb
- Highlight the adverb position in a second colour
- Right: errors for wrap-up

## Timing plan B

- **Late:** shorten the mingle to 3 names
- **Early:** class poll — "Who usually...?" and draw a quick bar chart on the board

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# Have You Ever...?

B1 | Teens, 13–16 | 20 minutes

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|---|---|
| **Aim** | Students can talk about life experiences with the present perfect and add details with the past simple. |
| **Language** | **Have you ever been abroad?** — Yes, I have. I went to Thailand in 2024. / No, I haven't. ever = in your life, time not important · follow-up in past simple: When did you...? Who did you go with? |
| **Materials** | Teacher's "Two truths and a lie" sentences, timeline drawing, 1 "Have you ever" bingo sheet per student |

## Stages

**0–3 min — Warm-up: Two truths and a lie** Whole class
Tell three experiences ("I've lived in China. I've met a famous singer. I've eaten a scorpion."). Students vote for the lie.

**3–8 min — Present the language** T → class
Use the true ones to draw a life timeline. Elicit "Have you ever...?" and the short answers. Add a follow-up: "When did you go?"
**CCQs:** "Do we know when? (No.) Is it important? (No.) When we say *when*, which tense? (Past simple.)"

**8–13 min — Bingo prep** Individual → pairs
Students complete bingo questions with past participles (eat → eaten, see → seen, fly → flown), then check in pairs.
**ICQs:** "Do you ask yet? (No, just write.)"

**13–18 min — Experience bingo** Mingle
Students ask "Have you ever...?" A "yes" gets the name plus one past-simple follow-up. Three in a row wins.
**ICQs:** "After 'yes', what do you ask? (One more question.)" Monitor.

**18–20 min — Feedback** Whole class
Winners share the most surprising answer. Correct two errors together ("I have went..."). Specific praise.

## Board plan

- Left: irregular past participles
- Centre: timeline — Have you ever + past participle? / follow-up past simple
- Mark the switch from 'ever' to a specific time
- Right: errors for wrap-up

## Timing plan B

- **Late:** play to one line of bingo, not three
- **Early:** students write their own "two truths and a lie" and guess in groups

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# Agreeing and Disagreeing in Meetings

B2 | Adults, business English | 20 minutes

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|---|---|
| **Aim** | Students can agree and disagree politely in a meeting, softening disagreement to keep good relationships. |
| **Language** | **Agree:** Exactly. · I couldn't agree more. · That's a good point.<br>**Disagree softly:** I see your point, but... · I'm not sure I agree. · That's true, although... |
| **Materials** | Short meeting dialogue (printed), blunt-sentence slips, role cards for a team-planning meeting |

## Stages

**0–3 min — Warm-up: Where do you stand?** Whole class

Read "Working from home is more productive." Students stand on a line from *agree* to *disagree* and give one reason.

**3–8 min — Notice the language** Pairs → class

Students read a short meeting dialogue and underline phrases for agreeing and disagreeing. Sort them on the board: strong / soft.

**CCQs:** "Is 'I'm not sure I agree' strong or soft? (Soft.) Why use soft language with a client? (To stay polite.)"

**8–13 min — Soften it** Pairs

Pairs rewrite blunt slips ("That's wrong." "Bad idea.") into polite versions, then read them with friendly intonation.

**ICQs:** "Do we keep the meaning? (Yes.) Do we change the tone? (Yes.)"

**13–18 min — Meeting role-play** Groups of 3–4

Plan a team-building day on a small budget. Each person has a role card with a different priority. Everyone must use two new phrases.

**ICQs:** "How many phrases? (Two.) Do you need to agree in the end? (Yes, one plan.)" Monitor.

**18–20 min — Feedback** Whole class

Each group shares its plan. Board good phrases heard and two to improve. Specific praise.

## Board plan

- Left: Agree / Disagree softly columns
- Centre: blunt → polite examples
- Right: phrases heard in the role-play and two corrections

## Timing plan B

- **Late:** skip the group's report, go straight to language feedback
- **Early:** swap roles and restart the meeting with a new budget

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# IELTS Speaking: Parts 1, 2 and 3

IELTS | Adults, band 5.5–6.5 target | 20 minutes

| | |
|---|---|
| **Aim** | Students know the format of each Speaking part and use one simple answer strategy for each. |
| **Language** | **Part 1:** Answer + Reason + Example (2–3 sentences)<br>**Part 2:** 1 min of keyword notes → talk for 2 min, following the bullets<br>**Part 3:** Opinion + Reason + Example + Other side |
| **Materials** | Part 1 question cards, one Part 2 cue card per student, Part 3 question slips, a timer |

## Stages

**0–2 min** — **Warm-up** Whole class
Ask "Do you like your hometown?" Show two answers: "Yes." vs a full A+R+E answer. "Which gets a better score? Why?"

**2–7 min** — **Part 1: everyday topics** T → class, pairs
Board the A+R+E formula with an example. Pairs ask each other Part 1 cards and extend each answer.
**ICQs:** "How many sentences? (Two or three.) Long speech? (No.)"

**7–13 min** — **Part 2: the long turn** Individual → pairs
Cue card: "Describe a place you like to visit." Students take 1 minute for keyword notes, one per bullet. Partner times a 1-minute talk (2 minutes in the real test).
**Tip:** Notes, not sentences. Follow the bullets in order and finish with feelings.

**13–18 min** — **Part 3: discussion** Pairs
Questions linked to Part 2: "Why do people travel more than in the past?" Board O+R+E+O. Pairs answer, using "On the other hand..." for the other side.
**ICQs:** "Is Part 3 about you or people in general? (People in general.)"

**18–20 min** — **Wrap-up** Whole class
Recap the three formulas. Link them to scoring: fluency, vocabulary, grammar, pronunciation. One tip per part.

## Board plan

- Three columns: Part 1 / Part 2 / Part 3 with each formula
- Part 2: example keyword notes
- Useful linkers: because, for example, on the other hand

## Timing plan B

- **Late:** do Part 3 as one whole-class question
- **Early:** students give each other a Part 1 band score using one criterion